

Daily Packet: 2026-05-15 to 2026-05-16

Trading_and_investment_papers plus Daily Shot when available.

WINDOW PDFS 11	CHART EXTRACTS 32	TOP CHARTS 5
DAILY SHOT skipped		

Bottom line: This packet is the one-stop morning read: curated chart evidence first, Daily Shot context second, and source links at the end.

Top Charts

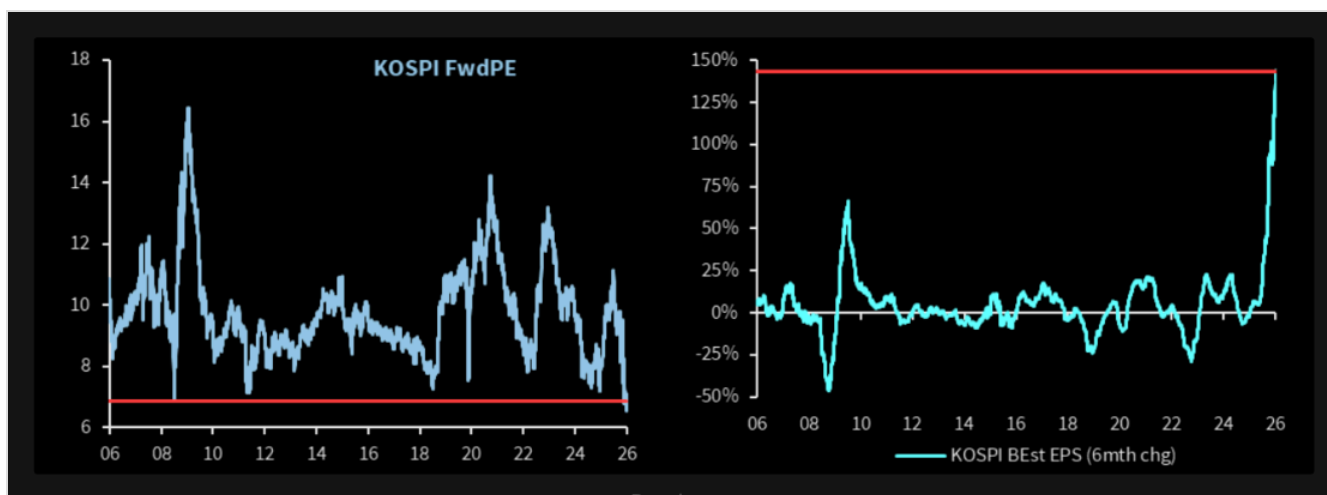
1. Korea's melt-up is earnings-backed, but increasingly stretched

2026-05-15 | the first real crack in the ai melt up 1 | page 3 [source PDF](#)

What it says: the first real crack in the ai melt up 1: LSEG Workspace Fundamentals KOSPI trading at 20-year lows in P/E multiples as consensus EPS estimates have been revised roughly 150% higher over the past six months. Things always look great following huge runs... Barclays Korea downside As we outlined earl...

Worldview update: The strongest tape is not pure speculation. Korea still has earnings revision support and compressed valuation, but the speed of the move means upside is becoming more fragile.

Portfolio/use: Respect the earnings support, but avoid treating a fast vertical move as low-risk beta. Watch revisions and reversal candles.



2. Options are shaping the path of the underlying

2026-05-15 | the melt up keeps sucking people in | page 1 [source PDF](#)

What it says: the melt up keeps sucking people in: The Melt-Up Keeps Sucking People In The upside chase keeps pulling investors aggressively into AI, semis, momentum, and upside volatility. At the same time, breadth keeps deteriorating, downside protection is getting abandoned, and several positioning dynam...

Worldview update: The rally has become more flow-mechanical. Fundamentals still matter, but call demand, vol compression, and dealer positioning are first-order timing variables.

Portfolio/use: Favor defined-risk upside and start adding downside while hedges are ignored.



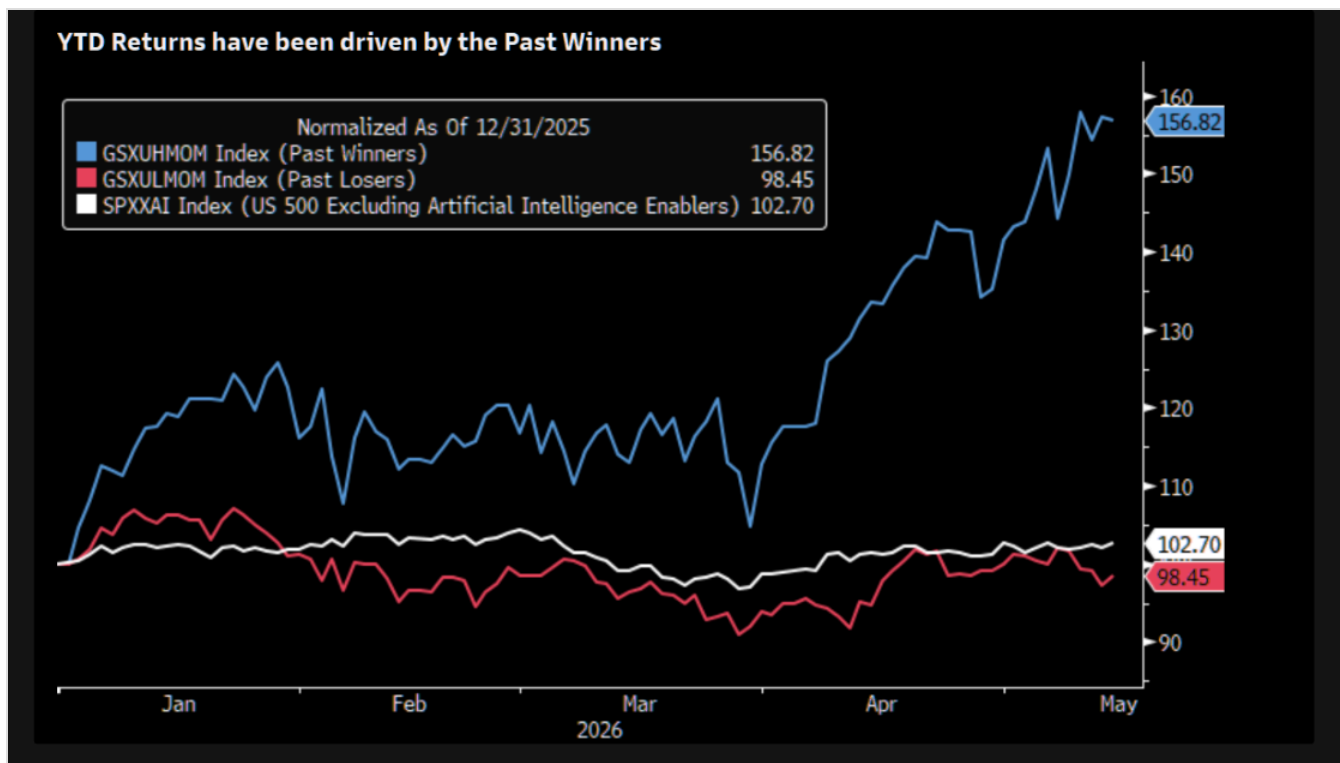
3. Breadth is narrowing beneath the index

2026-05-15 | the momentum trade is one ceasefire away from total carnage 1 | page 2 [source PDF](#)

What it says: the momentum trade is one ceasefire away from total carnage 1: Marquee High realized vol Realized volatility of momentum is at a multi-year high. As we all know, we are at one of the narrowest levels in terms of market breadth since the Dot-Com Bubble and briefly in 2023. Historically, the momentum factor has realized a...

Worldview update: SPX strength is increasingly an index-concentration signal. The macro read from headline index levels is polluted by a few large leaders.

Portfolio/use: Separate SPX direction from equal-weight health; prefer relative-value hedges over blunt index shorts.



4. Earnings are still carrying more weight than bears want

2026-05-15 | ford is apparently an ai company now 1 | page 3 [source PDF](#)

What it says: ford is apparently an ai company now 1: @cyclewatcher 0 FCF is now ok BofA now sees cloud/hyperscale aggregate FCF margin to reach ~0% by 2026-27 and they love it because, you know, it is the future.... "We see the AI capex cycle as sustainable as hyperscaler spending is increasingly supported by...

Worldview update: The bearish macro case needs earnings to crack. Until that happens, selloffs can remain buyable even if the rally quality deteriorates.

Portfolio/use: Track breadth of EPS revisions, not just index EPS. Narrow earnings strength is less durable.

"Hindenburg" Signals (>1.6) 2% from ATH



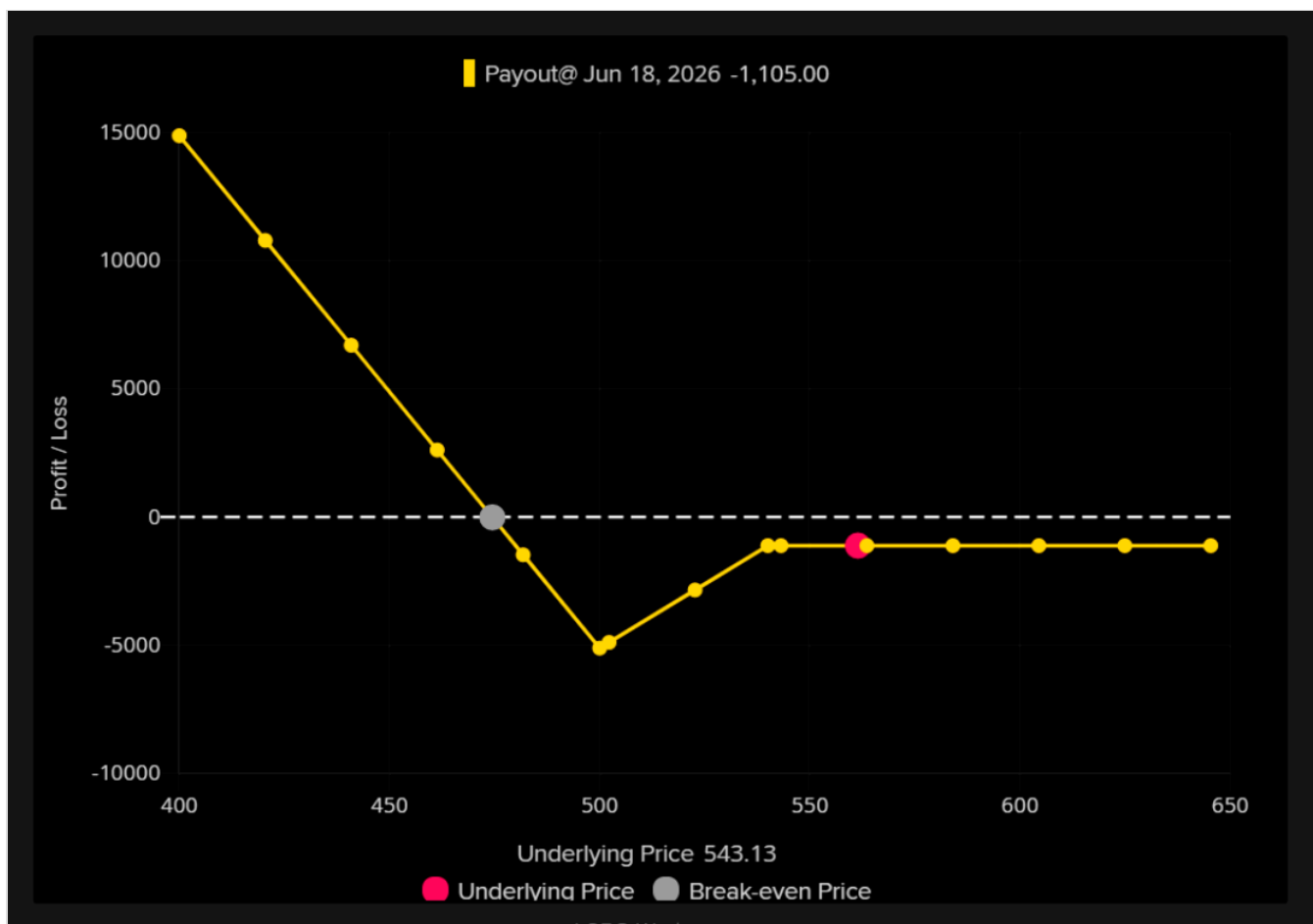
5. AI is becoming a capex, power, and politics story

2026-05-16 | One Of Tech's Biggest Rotations Is Brewing | page 2 [source PDF](#)

What it says: One Of Tech's Biggest Rotations Is Brewing: LSEG Workspace LSEG Workspace IGV IGV has bounced aggressively since hitting major range lows some weeks ago. Software has consolidated over the past week, but continues inching higher. A close above \$92 could re-ignite the squeeze. Note we are already back...

Worldview update: The AI trade is no longer only about demand and model progress. The constraint is shifting toward cash-flow intensity, grid capacity, permitting, and public tolerance.

Portfolio/use: Map AI exposure through power, grid, utilities, gas, and capex beneficiaries; be careful where capex consumes free cash flow.



Daily Shot

Additional Chart Selection

6. The inventory cycle may be turning earlier than expected

2026-05-15 | Nomura Cross Asset BUYERS ARE HIGHER BUT THE BIGGER THEY COME THE | page 1 [source PDF](#)

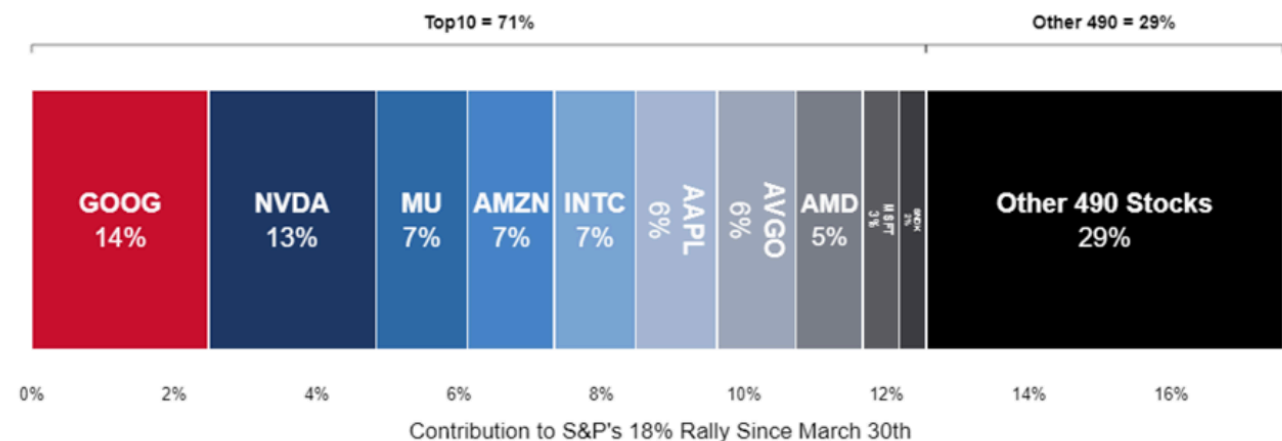
What it says: Nomura Cross Asset BUYERS ARE HIGHER BUT THE BIGGER THEY COME THE: Some eyes on Rates again, as Macro can return to a role as primary catalyst after the “Micro Calm” of + + + Equities Earnings...where after the UST long-end supply yday and growing “Hawkish Concern” globally via the still-not-solved Energy / Petrochem supply sh...

Worldview update: A restocking impulse would keep nominal growth firmer than survey pessimism implies. That complicates simple slowdown trades.

Portfolio/use: Do not over-index on soft data if imports, orders, and inventory data confirm a turn.

S&P 500 Return Contribution Since March 30th

Ten Stocks Drove 71% of the 18% Rally



Source: Nomura Vol

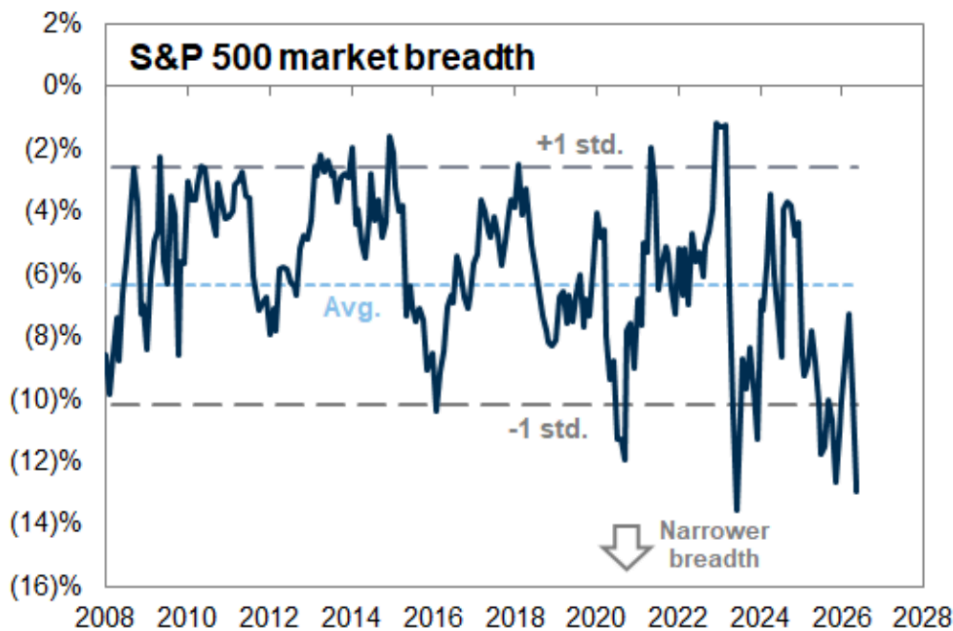
7. Retail attention is a crowding signal again

2026-05-15 | GETTING STOPPED IN | page 2 [source PDF](#)

What it says: GETTING STOPPED IN: Retail trading activity has also clearly inflected higher. Our trading desk estimates show that retail trading volumes have risen by 28% since mid-April and a basket of retail favorite stocks (GSXURFAV) has rallied by 29% over the same period. The recent...

Worldview update: Retail flow is no longer just background noise. It is reinforcing single-name momentum and can stretch valuations past fundamentals.

Portfolio/use: Treat retail favorites as path-dependent momentum trades; use options or tight risk rather than valuation-only shorts.



Market breadth calculated as the difference between the distance of the aggregate S&P 500 Index from its 52-week high and the distance of the median S&P 500 constituent from its 52-week high. When the aggregate index is much closer to its 52-week high than is the median stock, market breadth is narrow.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Sources

[Chart report PDF](#)